

Session Chat Transcript

Generated as PDF, 2026-09-24 — Topic: Excluding packages when creating JAR files in `AllVersionsJarMoreThanOnePackage.java`

USER

Don't change any code. Tell me conceptually how to make `AllVersionsJarMoreThanOnePackage.java` how to exclude certain folders that way certain packages are excluded?

ASSISTANT

The core of it is in `MakeJarUsingmsdos` — the `jar` command packs everything with the trailing `.` as "include everything under the current directory":

```
Line 144 (no package case): jar.exe cfm ...\\ForJava...jar mf.txt .  
Line 151/154 (package case): same, with .
```

Since `.` recursively includes every subfolder, all packages end up in the jar. The `jar` tool has **no `exclude/--exclude` flag**, so you can't just add a "skip this folder" option to the command. Conceptually, there are three standard ways:

1. Whitelist instead of blacklist (recommended). Replace `.` with explicit `-C <dir> <packagepath>` arguments, one per package you *want*:

```
jar.exe cfm out.jar mf.txt -C dir com/app/keep -C dir org/other/keep
```

"Excluding package X" becomes "list every package except X." Only works well with a known, finite list of packages.

2. Stage to a temp folder. Copy compiled output to a temp directory, walk the tree from `dir`, skip any subfolder whose package name matches an exclusion list, then run `jar cfm ... .` against the temp folder and delete it afterward. Cleanest true "exclusion" approach.

3. Delete before packaging. The code already has precedent for this — `allfiles.delete()` in `isMatthewJavaEditor` (line 134) and existing-jar deletions at lines 163-173. Delete unwanted `.class` trees, then `jar` with `..`. Riskier since it mutates the real output directory.

Exclusions only matter in the `else` branch (line 149, when `packager.isInRightFolders()` is true) — that's the multi-package scenario, where `dir` is on **line 31** (`packager.classpath`).

USER

I chose option 1. Please teach me what `<dir>` would be if I want to include `C:\Users\Owner\Documents\javaeditor\withjavafx\` for `javaeditor.withjavafx` folder?

ASSISTANT

Your `dir` is **`C:\Users\Owner\Documents`** — because `jar`'s `-C <dir>` wants the *base* directory (the parent of the package root folder), and your package root `javaeditor` lives at `C:\Users\Owner\Documents\javaeditor`. That's exactly what `Packager.isInRightFolders()` computes as `classpath` (`Packager.java:86`), which becomes `this.dir` in your class (`AllVersionsJarMoreThanOnePackage.java:31`).

So the full `jar` command becomes:

```
jar.exe cfm <out>.jar mf.txt -C C:\Users\Owner\Documents javaeditor/withjavafx
```

- `<dir>` = `C:\Users\Owner\Documents` (no backslash normalization needed).
- Entry uses **forward slashes**: `javaeditor/withjavafx`, recursively packing that folder and everything under it.

Two things to keep in mind:

1. **Your `dir` already equals `C:\Users\Owner\Documents`** in the `isInRightFolders()` path, so use `-C <dir> javaeditor/withjavafx` — no new variable needed.
2. This is per-package whitelist. Add one `-C <dir> <pkgpath>` per package you want, e.g. `-C <dir> javaeditor/withjavafx -C <dir> javaeditor/minorbugsfix`. Packages you don't list are automatically excluded.

USER

I mean teach me for `jar.exe` command?

ASSISTANT

The full `jar.exe` command would be:

```
jar.exe cfm MyApp.jar mf.txt -C C:\Users\Owner\Documents javaeditor/withjavafx
```

Breakdown:

- `cfm` = create jar, file name given, manifest file
- `MyApp.jar` = output jar
- `mf.txt` = your manifest
- `-C <dir> <path>` — the part that matters:
 - `<dir>` = `C:\Users\Owner\Documents` and
 - `<path>` = `javaeditor/withjavafx` (forward slashes)

`-C` doesn't mean "include from this folder" literally — it means "**temporarily switch to this directory, then include the following path relative to it.**" So `jar.exe` resolves:

```
C:\Users\Owner\Documents + javaeditor/withjavafx
-> C:\Users\Owner\Documents\javaeditor\withjavafx\ (included)
```

and stores it in the jar as `javaeditor/withjavafx/...` (the `<path>` is the name inside the jar).

Alternative: if you wanted entries named just `withjavafx/...` (no `javaeditor` prefix), move the base up a level:

```
jar.exe cfm MyApp.jar mf.txt -C C:\Users\Owner\Documents\javaeditor withjavafx
```

Here `<dir>` = `C:\Users\Owner\Documents\javaeditor` and `<path>` = `withjavafx`.

So the answer depends on the jar entry name you want — `C:\Users\Owner\Documents` keeps `javaeditor/withjavafx/...` entries; `C:\Users\Owner\Documents\javaeditor` gives `withjavafx/...` entries.

USER

Great good job teaching me `jar.exe` but what would be command for two packages `javaeditor.withjavafx` and `javaeditor.minorbugsfix` inside `C:\Users\Owner\Documents`?

ASSISTANT

```
jar.exe cfm MyApp.jar mf.txt -C C:\Users\Owner\Documents javaeditor/withjavafx -C  
C:\Users\Owner\Documents javaeditor/minorbugsfix
```

-C <dir> <path> only applies to the single path that follows it, so you repeat the pair for each package. Resulting jar entries:

```
javaeditor/withjavafx/...  
javaeditor/minorbugsfix/...
```

You cannot shorten it to -C C:\Users\Owner\Documents javaeditor/withjavafx javaeditor/minorbugsfix — the second path would be treated as relative to the original working directory. Stick with one -C per package.

USER

Can you generate a pdf as a list of this whole session chat?

ASSISTANT

This PDF was generated from this chat session using Microsoft Edge headless mode.